Forklift maintenance schedule

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For propane, gas, diesel and electric warehouse forklifts. OSHA requires a check before the truck goes to work, and a truck that fails it gets parked until it's fixed, not run to the end of the shift.

Based on OSHA 1910.178 and manufacturer planned-maintenance schedules. Your truck's manual comes first.

Before every shift (key off, then key on)

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Walk around: leaks, tires, forks, overhead guard	Before each shift	Fuel, hydraulic oil, engine oil, coolant, battery acid	
Mast chains, hydraulic hoses and stops	Before each shift		
Fluid levels: engine oil, hydraulic, coolant, brake	Before each shift	Electric trucks: hydraulic and brake fluid	
LP trucks: tank, bracket and hose	Before each shift	Rust, dents, damage	
Electric trucks: battery charge, water, restraint	Before each shift	Battery held down and fastened	
Seat belt and capacity plate in place	Before each shift	Plate has to match the truck and any attachment	
Brakes, parking brake and steering	Before each shift	Engine or motor running	
Lift, lower, tilt and attachment controls	Before each shift		
Horn, lights, alarms and gauges	Before each shift	Investigate any strange noise right away	

Electric trucks: battery

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Check the water level	About every 5 charges		
Top off with water	About every 10 charges	Only after a full charge, never before	
Equalize charge	Every 5 to 10 charges	Or what your battery maker says	

Planned maintenance (by hours)

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Engine oil and filter (gas, LP, diesel)	Every 250 hours or 6 months	Whichever comes first	
Air filter	Every 250 hours or 6 months	Engine trucks	
Lubricate mast, chains, carriage and linkages	Every 250 hours or 6 months		
Brake linings, parking brake, wheel nut torque	Every 250 hours or 6 months		
Seat belt, latches, labels, hoses for wear	Every 250 hours or 6 months		
Hydraulic oil and filter	Per your manual	Intervals vary a lot by model	

Required by code? OSHA 1910.178 requires every powered industrial truck to be examined at least daily before it's put in service, and after each shift when trucks run around the clock. A truck that isn't safe has to come out of service until it's repaired. OSHA also requires each operator's performance to be evaluated at least every 3 years. Code items apply where your city, state or insurer has adopted them. Requirements vary by jurisdiction, so check local code.

Service log: forklift

Machine / unit: _____ Make & model: _____

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DATE	HOURS	WORK DONE	PARTS USED	INITIALS

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